

Word family: **ask / asks / asked / asking**

Base word: ask

Past tense: asked

Past participle: asked

Related forms: asking

Useful extensions: ask a question, ask for, ask about, ask someone to do something, ask someone if/whether, ask oneself, ask around

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “He also **asks** endless questions about how things work.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **ask** means:

> **to say or write something in order to get information, an answer, or an explanation**

繁體中文： **詢問；發問；向某人提出問題以獲得資訊、答案或解釋**

中文翻譯：

> “He also asks endless questions about how things work.”

「他也會不停地**問問題**，想知道各種東西是怎樣運作的。」

Here:

ask questions = 提出問題以尋求資訊或答案

1. **ask a question = request information (詢問) — 問；詢問**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He also **asks** endless questions about how things work.”

「他也會不停地**問問題**，想知道各種東西是怎樣運作的。」

Practice 2

> “She **asked** me a difficult question.”

「她**問了**我一條很難的問題。」

Practice 3

> “The child kept **asking** questions.”

「那個小朋友不停地**問問題**。」

ask = 為了獲得資訊、答案或解釋而提出問題

2. **ask someone something** (向某人詢問) — 問某人某事

A very common grammatical pattern.

Practice 4

> “I **asked him** his name.”

「我**問他**叫甚麼名字。」

Practice 5

> “She **asked the teacher** a question.”

「她**問老師**一條問題。」

ask someone something = 向某人提出某個問題

Pattern:

> **ask + person + question**

3. **ask about something** (詢問某事) — 詢問；問及

Practice 6

> “He **asked about** the new project.”

「他**詢問**新項目的情況。」

Practice 7

> “She **asked me about** my family.”

「她**問我有關**家人的事情。」

ask about X = 詢問與 X 有關的資訊

4. **ask for something (要求 / 索取) — 要求 ; 索取**

This is a major separate construction.

Practice 8

> “She **asked for** a glass of water.”

「她**要了一杯水**。」

Practice 9

> “He **asked for** more time.”

「他**要求更多時間**。」

ask for X = 表達希望獲得某物、某項服務或某種待遇

This is not simply asking a question.

5. **ask for help (尋求幫助) — 求助**

Practice 10

> “Don’t be afraid to **ask for help**.”

「不要害怕**尋求幫助**。」

Practice 11

> “She **asked for help** with her homework.”

「她**請求幫忙**做功課。」

****ask for help = 主動表示需要別人的協助****

6. ****ask someone to do something (要求某人做某事) — 要求 / 請某人做****

Another major grammatical construction.

Practice 12

> “I ****asked him to wait****.”

「我****叫他等一下****。」

Practice 13

> “She ****asked me to help****.”

「她****請我幫忙****。」

****ask someone to do something = 要求或請求某人做某事****

The politeness can range from a simple request to a stronger instruction, depending on context and tone.

7. ****ask someone if/whether... (詢問是否) — 問某人是否.....****

Practice 14

> “I ****asked her if**** she was ready.”

「我****問她是否**準備好了**。」

Practice 15

> “He ****asked whether**** we could come.”

「他****問我們是否**可以來**。」

****ask if/whether = 詢問某件事情是否成立或是否可以發生****

8. ****ask why/how/when/where... (詢問具體資訊) — 問為甚麼 / 怎樣 / 何時 / 哪裏****

Practice 16

> “She **asked why** he was late.”

「她**問他為甚麼**遲到。」

Practice 17

> “He **asked how** the machine worked.”

「他**問那部機器是怎樣運作的**。」

This is particularly close to your passage:

> **ask how things work**

= **詢問事物如何運作**

ask + question word = 尋求特定類型的資訊

9. **ask = invite (邀請) — 邀請**

A distinct but related use.

Practice 18

> “She **asked me to dinner**.”

「她**邀請我吃晚飯**。」

Practice 19

> “They **asked us to their wedding**.”

「他們**邀請我們參加婚禮**。」

ask someone to an event/meal = 邀請某人參加活動、聚會或用餐

This is different from simply requesting an action:

> ask him to dinner → 邀請他吃飯

> ask him to leave → 要求他離開

10. **ask someone out (約會) — 約某人出去 ; 約會**

A highly common phrasal extension.

Practice 20

> “He **asked her out**.”

「他**約她出去約會**。」

Practice 21

> “She finally **asked him out**.”

「她終於**主動約他約會**。」

ask someone out = 邀請某人外出約會

This is a fixed modern expression.

11. **ask for permission (請求許可) — 請求批准 / 許可**

Practice 22

> “You should **ask for permission** first.”

「你應該先**徵求許可**。」

Practice 23

> “He **asked his parents for permission**.”

「他向父母**請求許可**。」

ask for permission = 正式或明確地請求某人准許自己做某事

12. **ask a favour (請人幫忙) — 請某人幫忙**

Practice 24

> “Can I **ask you a favour**?”

「我可以**請你幫個忙**嗎？」

Practice 25

> “She **asked me a favour**.”

「她**請我幫一個忙**。」

ask a favour = 請求某人為自己做一些事情

Common pattern:

> **ask someone a favour**

or:

> **ask a favour of someone**

13. **ask someone's opinion (詢問意見) — 徵求意見**

Practice 26

> “I **asked her opinion**.”

「我**問她的意見**。」

Practice 27

> “He **asked me what I thought**.”

「他**問我有甚麼看法**。」

ask someone's opinion = 主動尋求某人的看法、判斷或建議

14. **ask the price / ask how much (詢問價格) — 問價錢**

Practice 28

> “I **asked how much** it cost.”

「我**問它多少錢**。」

Practice 29

> “She **asked the price** before buying it.”

「她買之前先**問價錢**。」

ask the price = 詢問某物的價格

15. **ask a price / ask for a price (索價) — 開價 ; 索取某個價格**

A distinct commercial use.

Practice 30

> “They are **asking** £500 for the table.”

「他們這張桌子**開價**五百英鎊。」

Practice 31

> “How much are they **asking for** the car?”

「他們那輛車**要價**多少？」

ask X for something = 要求某物的價格 / 為某物索取某個金額

This is different from:

> ask how much it costs

where you are simply requesting information.

16. **ask for something = demand/request formally (要求) — 要求某物**

Practice 32

> “The workers **asked for** better conditions.”

「工人**要求**更好的工作條件。」

Practice 33

> “The group **asked for** an explanation.”

「該團體**要求**一個解釋。」

ask for = 明確表示希望獲得某物、某種待遇或某項行動

Depending on context, **ask for** can be a polite request or a strong demand.

17. **ask** = invite someone to speak / call on (邀請發言) — 請某人回答 / 發言

Practice 34

> “The teacher **asked** Leo to answer.”

「老師**請** Leo 回答。」

Practice 35

> “She **asked him** to explain his idea.”

「她**請**他解釋自己的想法。」

ask someone = 要求 / 邀請某人提供回答、解釋或發言

18. **ask** = seek advice/guidance (請教) — 請教；徵詢

Practice 36

> “She **asked** her grandmother for advice.”

「她向祖母**請教**。」

Practice 37

> “I **asked** my teacher what I should do.”

「我**請教**老師我應該怎樣做。」

ask someone for advice = 向某人尋求意見、建議或指導

19. **ask oneself (自問) — 自問；思考**

Practice 38

> “I **asked myself** whether I had made the right choice.”

「我**問自己**是否作出了正確的選擇。」

Practice 39

> “She **asked herself** why she felt so nervous.”

「她**自問**自己為甚麼會如此緊張。」

ask oneself = 在心中提出問題並思考答案

20. **ask around (四處打聽) — 四處詢問；向不同的人打聽**

A common phrasal extension.

Practice 40

> “I’ll **ask around** and see if anyone knows.”

「我會**四處問問**，看看有沒有人知道。」

Practice 41

> “She **asked around** about the best restaurant.”

「她**向不同的人打聽**哪間餐廳最好。」

ask around = 向幾個不同的人詢問，以取得資訊

21. **ask back (反問) — 反問**

A useful but lower-priority extension.

Practice 42

> “He answered, then **asked back**, ‘Why?’”

「他回答後反過來**問道**：「為甚麼？」」

Practice 43

> “She **asked back** whether that was really necessary.”

「她**反問**那是否真的有必要。」

ask back = 對剛才的問題 / 說法作出反問

Lower priority than the main constructions.

22. **be asking for trouble** (自找麻煩) — 自找麻煩

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 44

> “You’re **asking for trouble** if you ignore the warning.”

「如果你無視警告，就是在**自找麻煩**。」

Practice 45

> “Driving that fast is **asking for trouble**.”

「開車開得那麼快根本就是**自找麻煩**。」

be asking for trouble = 做某件明顯可能帶來麻煩或危險的事情

23. **if you ask me** (依我看) — 依我看；我認為

A common conversational expression.

Practice 46

> “It’s too expensive, **if you ask me**.”

「**依我看**，這太貴了。」

Practice 47

> “He needs a break, **if you ask me**.”

「**依我看**，他需要休息一下。」

if you ask me = 表示「以我的看法」或「如果你問我的意見」

24. **ask for it** (自找麻煩) — 自找麻煩 / 自找惡果

Practice 48

> “He knew it was dangerous, but he **asked for it**.”

「他知道那樣很危險，但他根本是**自找的**。」

Practice 49

> “If you keep provoking him, you’re **asking for it**.”

「如果你繼續挑釁他，就是在**自找麻煩**。」

ask for it = 做某些事情而招致本可預見的負面後果

This is informal.

Important distinction: **ask vs say**

ask

= seek information / a response / permission / something.

> “She **asked** where he was.”

say

= produce or communicate words/statements.

> “She **said** that he was outside.”

A question normally uses **ask**, not **say**.

Important distinction: **ask vs tell**

ask

usually seeks a response:

> “Ask him to come.”

tell

usually gives information or an instruction:

> “Tell him to come.”

So:

> **ask him to come**

> = 請 / 叫他來

> **tell him to come**

> = 告訴 / 吩咐他來

Important distinction: **ask vs request**

ask

is the ordinary everyday verb.

request

is more formal and often sounds more official.

> “I asked for help.”

> “I requested assistance.”

Both can mean **請求**, but **ask** is much more common in everyday English.

Important distinction: **ask vs question**

As verbs:

ask

= put a question to someone.

question

= ask someone in a more deliberate, detailed, or sometimes doubtful/investigative way.

> “The teacher asked him a question.”

> “The police questioned him.”

question can imply an investigation or challenge that ordinary **ask** does not.

Important distinction: **ask for** vs **ask about**

This is essential.

ask for

= want/seek something.

> “She asked for help.”

= 她要求 / 尋求幫助。

ask about

= want information about something.

> “She asked about the problem.”

= 她詢問那個問題的情況。

Important distinction: **ask someone something** vs **ask someone for something**

ask someone something

= ask them a question.

> “I asked him his name.”

ask someone for something

= request something from them.

> “I asked him for his phone number.”

So:

> **ask him his name** → 問他的名字

> **ask him for his name** → 向他索取 / 詢問他的名字

Both can be grammatical, but the structures differ.

Important distinction: **ask someone to do vs ask someone about**

ask someone to do X

= request that they perform X.

> “I asked her to wait.”

ask someone about X

= seek information about X.

> “I asked her about the problem.”

Important distinction: **ask for permission vs ask if**

ask for permission

= request authorization.

> “I asked for permission to leave.”

ask if

= inquire whether something is true/possible.

> “I asked if I could leave.”

They often communicate the same practical situation, but grammatically they are different constructions.

Important distinction: **ask vs invite**

This is particularly useful:

> “She asked me to dinner.”

can mean:

invite me to dinner

But:

> “She asked me to leave.”

means:

requested that I leave

The noun/activity following **to** determines the meaning.

Important distinction: **ask a question vs ask for an answer**

ask a question

= 提出問題。

ask for an answer

= 要求對方給出答案。

So **ask** can either initiate an information exchange or explicitly request a response.

Family-extension note

Ask is a very strong **grammar-rich polysemy candidate**. Its central meaning is relatively

stable—**seeking something from another person through speech or communication**—but English has several highly useful lexicalized constructions:

* **ask a question**
 * **ask for**
 * **ask about**
 * **ask someone to do**
 * **ask if/whether**
 * **ask someone out**
 * **ask around**
 * **come to someone's rescue** does *not* belong here, but **ask for help** does
 * **ask for trouble**
 * **if you ask me**

The important point is not to split every grammatical pattern into an unrelated dictionary sense. Several are **constructional extensions of the same basic communicative act**, while others—such as **ask someone out** and **ask for trouble**—have become sufficiently lexicalized to be worth learning separately. This follows the manual's distinction between genuine lexical polysemy and ordinary grammatical multifunctionality.

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ask a question	為獲得資訊、答案或解釋而提出問題
ask someone something	向某人提出某個問題
ask about	詢問與某事有關的資訊
ask for	要求 / 索取某物、服務、待遇或行動
ask for help	主動尋求別人的協助
ask someone to do	要求 / 請某人做某事
ask if/whether	詢問某件事情是否成立 / 可行
ask why/how/when/where	詢問特定資訊
ask someone to dinner	邀請某人吃飯 / 赴宴
ask someone out	約某人出去約會
ask for permission	請求許可
ask a favour	請某人幫一個忙
ask someone's opinion	徵求某人的意見
ask the price	詢問價格
ask a price / ask for a price	開價 / 索價
ask for something	明確要求獲得某物 / 待遇 / 行動
ask someone to answer	請 / 要求某人回答或發言
ask for advice	向某人請教 / 尋求建議
ask oneself	自問；在心中思考
ask around	向不同的人四處打聽

ask back	反問	
ask for trouble	做某事而自找麻煩	
if you ask me	依我看；以我的意見	
ask for it	自找麻煩 / 自找惡果	

For your original sentence

> “He also **asks** endless questions about how things work.”

The exact meaning is:

ask = 為了取得資訊、答案或解釋而提出問題

More specifically:

> **ask questions about how things work**

= “「詢問各種東西是怎樣運作的」”

So this is the straightforward **information-seeking** sense of **ask**.

The particularly useful structure here is:

> **ask + question word + clause**

ask how...

ask why...

ask what...

ask where...

ask when...

In Leo's case:

> **asks how things work**

= “問東西是怎樣運作的”.